project.org

STUDENT HANDOUT

GREEN LEVEL
MORE SUPPORT

Seeing is Deceiving

Grades 5–8 · Art

ADMIT ONE

NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

What I learned. Our eyes and brain work together to see the world. Sometimes they make mistakes! When your brain guesses wrong about what you're seeing, that's called an **optical illusion**.

Key idea: Your brain doesn't just see—it interprets. It fills in gaps, makes assumptions, and sometimes gets tricked!

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PART 1

Observe an illusion

Look at the optical illusion your teacher shows you. Draw what you see below:

DRAW THE ILLUSION HERE

Answer these questions:

What did you see at first?

Did you see something different when you looked again?

Why do you think your brain saw it that way?

PART 2

02 Create your own simple illusion

Try making your own optical illusion! Here are some easy ideas:

- Draw a picture that looks like two different things (like the duck/rabbit)
- Draw lines that look bent but are actually straight
- Draw two shapes that look different sizes but are actually the same

CREATE YOUR ILLUSION HERE

Explain your illusion: What trick does it play on the eyes?

SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

Show your family an optical illusion from class or one you find online. Ask them: *"What do you see?"* See if they see it differently than you do!